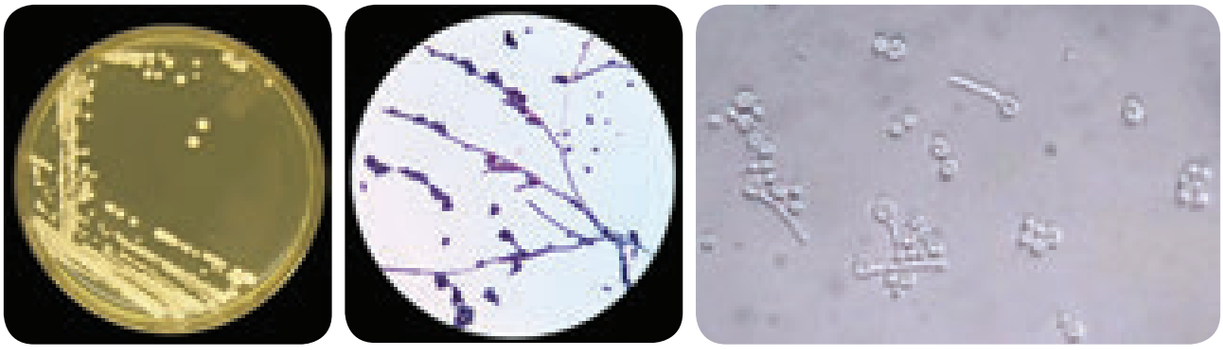


Figure 9.10: Candida **(a)** Macroscopic Morphology **(b)** Microscopic Morphology **(c)** Germ tube

the yeast cells. The demonstration of the germ tube is known as Reynolds – Braude phenomenon.

Biochemical tests

Sugar fermentation and assimilation tests are used for the identification of Candidal species. C.*albicans* ferments Glucose and Maltose and assimilates Glucose, Maltose, Sucrose, Lactose and Galactose.

Chlamydospores formation

Candida isolates are grown on corn meal, agar (CHN) or rice starch agar (RSA) and incubated at 25°C for 2–3 days. The formation of large, thick walled terminal chlamydospores is demonstrated in C.*albicans* and C. *dubliniensis*.

iii. Treatment

1. 1% gentian violet is locally applied to the affected areas.
2. The azole creams like Clotrimazole, Miconazole, Ketoconazole and Econazole are also used.

9.5.2 Cryptococcosis

Cryptococcosis is an acute, sub acute or chronic fungal disease caused by encapsulated yeast called *Cryptococcus neoformans*. It is pathogenic to man and animals. It causes opportunistic infection, involving the lungs and disseminates to extra pulmonary sites through circulation to different body organs particularly to central nervous system causing **Meningoencephalitis**.

Infobits

What does Cryptococcus cause?

Meningitis can be caused by different germs, including bacteria, **fungi**, and viruses. Two types of fungus can cause **cryptococcal meningitis** (CM). They are called Cryptococcus neoformans (C. *neoformans*) and Cryptococcus gattii (C. *gattii*). This disease is rare in healthy people.

Pathogenesis and Pathology

Cryptococcal infection occurs through inhalation of small forms or basidiospores. The fungus may remain dormant in the lungs until the immune system weakens and then can disseminate to the central nervous system and other body sites.

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